Elevate
QUALITY COMPLIANCE SOLUTIONS

ST-DLV-001

Startup SOP Template

Aligned with applicable standards and best practices | Version 1.0 | Elevate Quality Compliance Solutions LLC

Document Code ST-DLV-001	**Version** 1.0	**Effective Date** February 2026
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SAMPLE TEMPLATE — elevateqcs.com
Free to use. Need a fully editable Word / Excel version? Email info@elevateqcs.com with the document code and name above.

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1 How to Use This Template

This Startup SOP Template provides a standardised shell for documenting any business process. Duplicate this document for each procedure your organisation needs to define. Complete every shaded field; delete instructional text before publishing. Consistent SOPs demonstrate operational maturity to investors, auditors, and quality certification bodies.

HOW TO USE: *Fill in every grey/italic field. Delete this instruction box before distributing the finalised SOP. Each SOP should describe ONE process only. Link related SOPs in Section 9.*

2 Document Control Information

Document Title *[Name of this SOP — e.g. Client Onboarding Procedure]*	**Document Code** *[e.g. SOP-OPS-001]*
Version *1.0*	**Effective Date** *MM/DD/YYYY*
Process Owner (Role) *[e.g. Operations Manager]*	**Department / Function** *[e.g. Operations / Sales / Finance]*
Approved By *[Name, Title]*	**Next Review Date** *MM/DD/YYYY (annual recommended)*
Applicable Standards / Regulations *[e.g. ISO 9001:2015 Clause 7.5 / SOC 2 / none]*	

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3 Purpose

Describe why this procedure exists and what problem it solves. Keep to 2–3 sentences.

Enter purpose statement here...

4 Scope

Define what this SOP covers and — equally important — what it does NOT cover. Identify which teams, products, services, or geographies are in scope.

IN SCOPE	OUT OF SCOPE
List what this SOP applies to...	*List what this SOP does NOT cover...*

5 Roles & Responsibilities

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Role / Title	Responsibility in this Process	RACI
Process Owner	Overall accountability for this SOP being followed and kept current	**Accountable (A)**
Team Member / Operator	Executes the steps defined in this procedure	**Responsible (R)**
Manager / Supervisor	Approves outputs, reviews exceptions	**Consulted (C)**
[Add role as needed]	*[Describe responsibility]*	**Informed (I)**

6 Definitions & Abbreviations

Term / Abbreviation	Definition
SOP	Standard Operating Procedure — a documented, step-by-step instruction for completing a routine task
QMS	Quality Management System — the overarching framework governing quality processes
[Term]	*[Enter definition]*
[Term]	*[Enter definition]*

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7 Procedure Steps

List every step in sequential order. Be specific enough that a new team member could follow these steps without asking questions. Add or remove rows as needed.

Step	Action / Description	Responsible Role	Expected Output / Tool
1	*[Describe the trigger or starting condition for this process — e.g. 'Receive client enquiry via email or web form']*	*[Role]*	*[Tool / form / system used]*
2	*[Describe first action taken]*	*[Role]*	*[Output or record created]*
3	*[Describe second action taken]*	*[Role]*	*[Output or record created]*
4	*[Describe decision point or approval step if applicable]*	*[Role]*	*[Approval record / email]*
5	*[Describe next action]*	*[Role]*	*[Output]*
6	*[Describe final step / close-out action]*	*[Role]*	*[Completed record / notification]*
7	*[Add additional steps as needed]*		

8 Exceptions & Escalation

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Exception / Scenario	Escalation Action
[Describe a scenario not covered by normal steps]	*[Who to notify and what action to take]*
[Describe another exception]	*[Escalation path]*
Process cannot be completed due to missing information	Return to requestor; document reason for delay in log

9 Related Documents & References

Document / Reference	Document Code	Relationship
[Related SOP or policy name]	*[Code]*	*[Parent / Child / Reference]*
[Related form or template]	*[Code]*	*[Form used in step X]*
[Applicable regulation or standard]	*[e.g. ISO 9001:2015]*	*[Compliance requirement]*

10 Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
1.0	*MM/DD/YYYY*	*[Author Name]*	Initial release

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